

Family Cardinalidae

Cardinals, grosbeaks, and allies

Length 5–9 in (12.5–22 cm)

Species 69



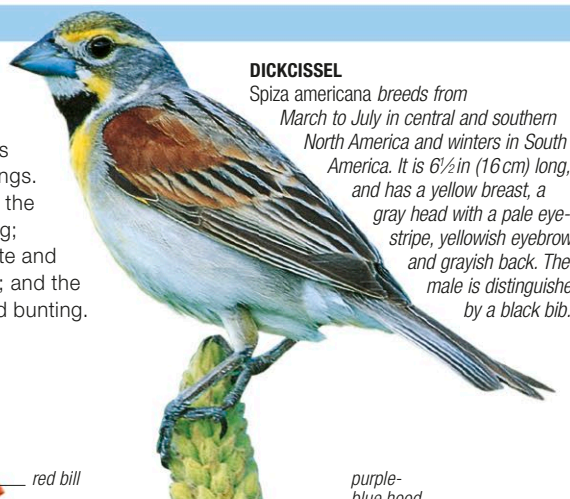
The defining feature of this group of woodland and scrub birds is the short, stoutly triangular bill, especially in the heavier-billed grosbeaks, used for manipulating and husking seeds. The group includes cardinals, grosbeaks, tanagers, seedeaters, saltators, the dickcissel, and North American buntings. Most have distinct male and female plumages. The male pyrrhuloxia is like a brown cardinal, with a bold red face and an

upright, pointed crest. Male summer tanagers are all-red, while scarlet tanagers are red with black wings. The buntings include the all-blue indigo bunting; the brightly blue, white and orange lazuli bunting; and the multicoloured painted bunting.



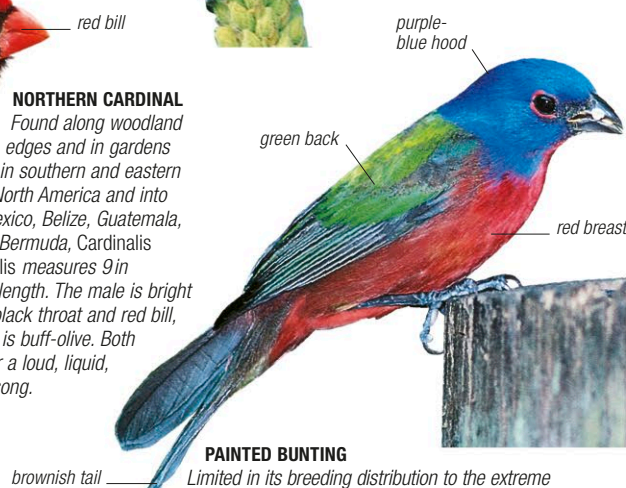
NORTHERN CARDINAL

Found along woodland edges and in gardens in southern and eastern North America and into Mexico, Belize, Guatemala, and Bermuda, *Cardinalis cardinalis* measures 9 in (22 cm) in length. The male is bright crimson with a black throat and red bill, and the female is buff-olive. Both sexes deliver a loud, liquid, whistling song.



DICKCISSEL

Spiza americana breeds from March to July in central and southern North America and winters in South America. It is 6½ in (16 cm) long, and has a yellow breast, a gray head with a pale eye-stripe, yellowish eyebrow, and grayish back. The male is distinguished by a black bib.



PAINTED BUNTING

Limited in its breeding distribution to the extreme southern states of the USA, *Passerina ciris* is one of the most colorful birds in North America. The male has a purple-blue hood and gaudy plumage; the female is bright green above and paler yellow-green below. This bunting is 5½ in (14 cm) long.

Family Coerebidae

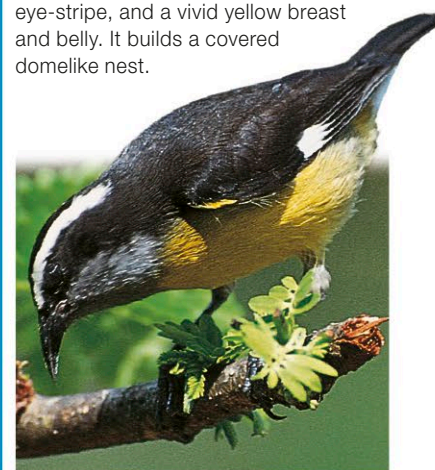
Bananaquit

Length 4¼ in (11 cm)

Species 1



Around 40 subspecies of *Coereba flaveola* have been identified. It is a familiar garden bird and ranges through northern and eastern South America and the Caribbean islands. The bananaquit is common in the northern part of its range, but relatively scarce deeper in the forest. It feeds mainly on nectar but also eats fruit. Both sexes have a black crown and mask, a white eye-stripe, and a vivid yellow breast and belly. It builds a covered domelike nest.



Family Parulidae

New World warblers

Length 4–6½ in (10–16 cm)

Species 119



New World warblers, known in the USA as wood warblers, include many brightly colored birds, with frequent splashes of orange and yellow in their plumage. New World warblers inhabit a wide

range of woodland and scrub habitat; many head from North America to Central and South America to spend the winter in tropical latitudes. The pressure of human habitation and agriculture have shrunk these areas, leading to a substantial decline in numbers of breeding birds. Although they are largely insectivorous, these birds also feed on fruit during migration. The songs of different New World warblers are generally well developed but are similar enough to confuse birdwatchers.



KIRTLAND'S WARBLER

Setophaga kirtlandii breeds only in jack pine woodland in Michigan, USA, and winters in the Bahamas. Habitat management has improved its nesting conditions. It is 6 in (15 cm) long, and both sexes (female pictured) have blue-gray upperparts and white eye-rings.



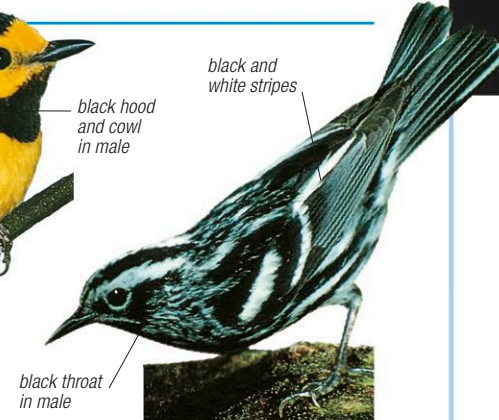
COMMON YELLOWTHROAT

Distributed across North America, *Geothlypis trichas*—which is 5 in (13 cm) long—winters in southern USA and South America, and prefers low vegetation in fields and swamps. The male has a black face mask bordered with gray, and yellow throat, breast, and undertail coverts. The female is similar but lacks the face mask.



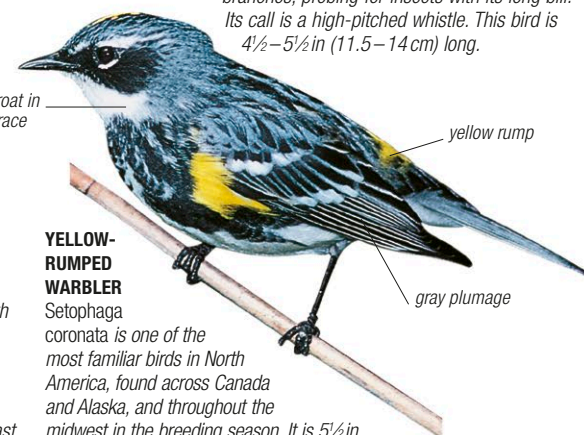
HOODED WARBLER

Setophaga citrina is an expert fly catcher that inhabits damp forest and wooded swamp, always on, or a few metres above, the ground. It breeds in eastern and central USA, and winters in Central America and the West Indies. This bird is 5½ in (14 cm) long, and both sexes flaunt white tail patches as they move about.



BLACK-AND-WHITE WARBLER

Breeding in Canada and eastern USA, *Mniotilta varia* winters in the south, as far as northern South America. It forages along branches, probing for insects with its long bill. Its call is a high-pitched whistle. This bird is 4½–5½ in (11.5–14 cm) long.



YELLOW-RUMPED WARBLER

Setophaga coronata is one of the most familiar birds in North America, found across Canada and Alaska, and throughout the midwest in the breeding season. It is 5½ in (14 cm) long. There are 2 subspecies, both with gray plumage and a yellow rump.